



“Sustainability is essential, but consumers don’t pay extra for it. Their choices reflect how responsible they perceive a company to be”

Q: On the global net-zero commitment, where does Nestlé India stand?

A: The interim net-zero target is 50% reduction by 2030, aiming for net zero by 2050. India is progressing well. The biggest challenge is climate action in dairy, a major part of our portfolio. We’ve pioneered bio-digesters (used to break down organic waste and produce biogas and fertilisers) on dairy farms (3,000 to 5,000 installed), significantly reducing greenhouse gases and methane. If the plan continues, we’ll meet our global goals.

Q: What is Nestlé India’s strategy?

A: Our strategy focuses on three areas. First is sustainable sourcing. Be it coffee, milk, spices or oils, 55–60% of our materials are sustainably sourced, with coffee nearing 100%. Then there is sustainable manufacturing and logistics. We use 100% renewable energy in factories, deploy electric fleets and work with partners on electric logistics. Manufacturing improvements have reduced water use by 20–25%, saving 190,000 cubic metres last year, and ensured energy savings of 89,000 gigajoules. Third is recycling and plastics. Last year, we generated 25,000 tonnes of plastic packaging, and collected and recycled as much as possible. We’ve been plastic neutral for four years, reduced virgin plastic use by 900 tonnes; 59–60% of packaging is designed for recycling. Recycling facilities are limited but improving, with government support.

Q: Has it been easy given the resource and technology constraints?

A: It’s challenging; much recycling isn’t yet environmentally optimal. We’ve urged policymakers and see growing awareness and action.

Q: You highlighted four areas: climate, packaging, water and sourcing. Why these?